

Chapter No. 1

INTRODUCTION TO
CIVICS

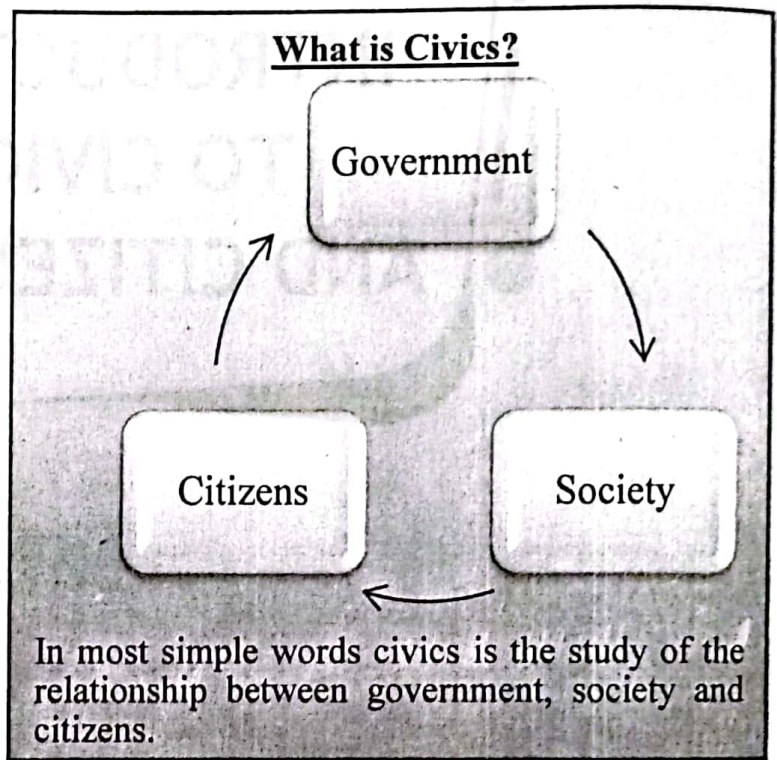
علم شہریت کیا ہے؟ What is Civics?

Civics is the prominent social science (نمایاں سوشل سائنس). Civics is the study of the obligations and rights (فرائض اور حقوق) of the various citizens in society. Therefore Civics can be discussed as a general study that speaks about everything surrounds human beings as well as leadership system (قادت کا نظام) that govern people. It speaks of internal and external affairs of the state including the history of human struggle as well as social, economic (معاشی) and political

advancement and transformation in human history. Civics is also concerned with the study of the government with a focus on the role played by citizens.

علم شہریت (سوکس) کا مفہوم Meaning and Origin of Civics

The word *Civics* is a derivative (اخذ کرنا) of its Latin (لاطینی) origin, *Civicus* or *Civitas*, which means *city* or *related to citizens*. The study of civics can be traced back to the ancient Greeks, who developed the first democratic government. Plato (افلاطون) and Aristotle (ارسطو) were two of the most famous Greek philosophers who wrote about civics and the importance of citizenship. In the Middle Ages, the study of civics was part of the training of those who were going into the government of the Church. In the Renaissance (نشاة ثانیہ کا دور), scholars such as Niccolò Machiavelli and Jean Bodin wrote about the relationship between citizens and rulers. In the 18th



century, philosophers such as Voltaire and Rousseau wrote about democracy and the rights of citizens.

Defining Civics علم شہریت کی تعریف

Civics can be defined as under:

- **F.J Gold:** Civics is a discipline of knowledge, which deals with institutions, habits, activities and sentiments, which provide an individual irrespective of gender, with a moral force to pay his duties and to enjoy a sense of belongingness with an organization.
- **E.M White:** Civics is a useful discipline of human knowledge, which deals with every aspect of human life covering his past, present and future aspects at local, national and global levels.
- **Patrick Gaddis:** Civics is a study of Civic life and its related issues.

According to some social philosophers Civics deals with the social aspect of human life; and all social, moral, political and religious institution are included in it. It also involves the study of local, provincial and federal Governments.

IMPORTANCE OF CIVICS علم شہریت کی اہمیت

The importance and significance of Civics can be explained as under:

1. **Sense of Rights and Responsibilities (حقوق اور ذمہ داریوں کا احساس):** Civics mainly deals with the study of human rights and responsibilities. Nobody can enjoy any benefit (فائدہ) of his rights if he is aware of his duties. After this awareness an individual can execute his citizenship effectively.
2. **Social Welfare (سماجی فلاح و بہبود):** Civics also develops a sense or feeling about social welfare in individual. So he prepares (تیار کرتا) himself to cooperate with the government in related activities. It also develops a healthy society, in which people conduct good virtues without any personal benefit but also for collective benefits.
3. **Knowledge about Social Issues (معاشرتی مسائل کا علم):** Most of social issues or social problems have direct impact on human life. In this situation, it is necessary to know about various social sciences including Civics. It will help to solve various social issues like political instability, corruption, nepotism, inflation, unemployment and so on.
4. **Understanding Government (حکومت کی سمجھ بوجھ):** Civics educates citizens about the structure and functioning of their government, fostering informed participation in democracy.
5. **Rule of Law (قانون کی حکمرانی):** Civics underscores the importance of the rule of law, ensuring that citizens respect and uphold legal principles.

6. **Help in National Politics**(قومی سیاست میں مدد) : People play a vital role in decision making about national politics and system of government. It is the actual beauty of democracy. So, in this sense Civics, equips people with the required knowledge as it encircles voting system, system of government, types of elections (direct or indirect) and the responsibilities of elected government.
7. **Good Manners and Healthy Habits**(اچھا رویہ اور عادات) : Civics also helps an individual to believe in virtues(نیکی) , brotherhood(بھائی چارہ) , sympathetic approach and unity. It deals with good habits among individual highlighting his good characteristics and develops him into a healthy personality.
8. **Assistance in International Affairs**(بین الاقوامی معاملات میں معاونت) : In this scientific and technological era the mutual relations of the citizens of different states has increased. Economical, political and cultural relations between various countries are getting stronger and stronger. This concept of global citizenship helps an individual to reduce or terminate regional and local prejudices. It makes a person an effective member of global society. It also helps him in the development of the zeal of coordination and cooperation with the people of the other nations.
9. **Critical Thinking**(تنقیدی فکر) : Civics promotes critical thinking skills, helping citizens evaluate policies, make informed decisions, and hold leaders accountable.
10. **Economic Affairs**(معاشی یا اقتصادی معاملات) : Civics enables a person to know about economic issues of his own country along with those of other nations. This discipline provides a person with the basic information about the economic affairs directly influence the person. The study of various global economic concepts and theories are very much therein the canvas of CIVICS. This helps a man in learning about dignity of labor the just means of earning livelihood.
11. **Rights and Responsibilities**(حقوق اور ذمہ داریاں) : It teaches individuals about their rights and civic responsibilities, empowering them to engage in civic activities effectively.
12. **Political Training**(سیاسی تربیت) : Civics helps in political training of a citizen as it leads him towards the basic knowledge about *political process* like voting, elections system & responsibilities of government. It also helps man about the detailed knowledge of rights and duties of individuals within a society.
13. **Social Cohesion**(سماجی اتحاد) : It fosters a sense of belonging and unity within a society, promoting tolerance, diversity, and social cohesion.
14. **Development of a Good Society**(اچھے معاشرے کی تشکیل) : Civics works as bridge between individual and various social institutions. A good society depends upon good individuals. It is Civics, which modifies collective approach and